

Overview of InnovatingHigherEd.com

Innovating Higher Ed is a hub for faculty, administrators and ed-tech innovators who want to understand how artificial intelligence (AI) and emerging technologies can transform higher education. The site is run by Dr. Norma Jones (host/producer) and Brent Jones (producer). According to the “About Us” page, Innovating Higher Ed’s mission is to **empower higher-education leaders, faculty and ed-tech innovators** by providing insights, strategies and real-world examples of AI-driven innovation [?innovatinghighered.com](#). They do this through podcasts, expert interviews and practical resources that help educators and administrators confidently navigate the rapidly evolving landscape of AI-driven teaching, learning and institutional innovation [?innovatinghighered.com](#). The site positions itself as a trusted partner for anyone looking to enhance classroom experiences, streamline operations or stay ahead of the latest ed-tech trends [?innovatinghighered.com](#).

Main Sections and Features

Section	Purpose / Key Details
Home (Peer-Created)	The home page highlights peer-created, classroom-tested AI tools “built by educators, for educators.” It underscores that these tools aren’t just generic AI products; they’ve been validated in classrooms by peers ?innovatinghighered.com .
Prompt Navigator	Offers a free prompt-guide with over 24 templates to help educators craft effective AI prompts. The guide is designed to save educators time by providing frameworks and ?innovatinghighered.com .
AI App Directory	A curated directory of AI applications that educators are using. The directory functions as a trusted guide to AI tools that have been vetted by peers.
Educator	Collection of classroom-tested tools created by educators. This section reinforces the “built by educators, for educators” ethos.
Podcast	Innovating Higher Ed Podcast hosted by Dr. Norma Jones. Episodes spotlight innovators who are transforming how we teach and engage students. The podcast often discusses ethical AI adoption, personalized learning, and practical classroom strategies
Tinker Lab	A workshop-style blog/podcast series where Dr. Norma Jones explores how tinkering with new ideas and AI tools can spark creativity and transform teaching and learning. The Tinker Lab page explicitly states that it is a “workshop for the mind” focused on experimentation ?innovatinghighered.com . Example posts include “The Workshop: Empowering Creativity & Ethical AI in Higher Education”
About Us	Summarizes the mission and introduces the team. It emphasizes a commitment to empowering education leaders through AI insights ?innovatinghighered.com .
Be Our Guest	Invitation for educators, researchers, or innovators to appear on the podcast and share their insights.

People Behind the Site

- **Dr. Norma Jones – Host/Producer:**
The “About Us” page describes Dr. Jones as a presenter, author, editor, keynote speaker

and communication expert whose career spans education, energy, law enforcement, international business, fine jewelry, e-commerce, multimedia entertainment and advertising [?](#)innovatinghighered.com. She is a recognized leader in AI initiatives in California and has helped many educators integrate AI into their classrooms and institutional strategies [?](#)innovatinghighered.com. Her expertise in communication and faculty development fosters inclusive, technology-enhanced learning environments that elevate student success [?](#)innovatinghighered.com. As the host of Innovating Higher Ed, she brings a dynamic speaking style and a deep understanding of both academic and corporate innovation to guide conversations about the future of education [?](#)innovatinghighered.com.

- **Brent Jones – Producer:**

Brent Jones has over two decades of experience producing and editing content for major networks (Warner Bros., ABC, CBS, Discovery Channel, History Channel) and previously ran post-production at Matchframe Film and Video. In 2023 he pivoted to AI, developing innovative AI-driven startups. At Innovating Higher Ed, he combines creative direction with technical precision to ensure high-quality episodes.

Reflection on Our Chats

In this session we explored InnovatingHigherEd.com to understand its mission and offerings. We visited the home page, which highlighted peer-created educator tools and a free prompt guide.

We then navigated to the “About Us” page to read the mission statement and team bios [?](#)innovatinghighered.com. Finally, we checked the Tinker Lab page, which features a series of posts that encourage educators to tinker with AI tools to spark creativity [?](#)innovatinghighered.com. There were no previous chat sessions in this conversation about the site, so this summary reflects the information gathered in our current exploration.

Future Plans and What the Site Stands For

While the site does not lay out a detailed long-term roadmap, its mission and existing content suggest the following future direction:

- **Continuously Curated Resources:** Keep expanding the **AI App Directory** and **Educator Tools** with classroom-tested AI tools. By emphasizing peer-created resources, the site signals a commitment to trustworthy and practical solutions.
- **Expanded Prompt Guidance:** Maintain and update the **Prompt Navigator** with more templates and frameworks to help educators design effective AI prompts for various disciplines.
- **Ongoing Podcast & Guest Features:** Continue producing podcast episodes featuring innovators who are transforming higher education, focusing on human-centered AI

strategies, ethical considerations, and practical case studies. The “Be Our Guest” section indicates a desire to involve more voices from the field.

- **Experimental Learning via Tinker Lab:** The Tinker Lab will likely continue to release experimental frameworks (e.g., the Wonka-Lantern Framework) and hands-on explorations of new AI tools, encouraging educators to experiment and share their findings [innovatinghighered.com](https://www.innovatinghighered.com).
- **Advocacy for Ethical, Inclusive AI:** The About Us page emphasizes empowerment, inclusivity and ethical AI integration [innovatinghighered.com](https://www.innovatinghighered.com). Future goals likely include advocating for equitable access to AI technologies and helping institutions develop policies that prioritize ethics and student success.

Overall, InnovatingHigherEd.com stands for **innovation with purpose** — using AI and emerging technologies ethically to empower educators, enhance student learning and streamline educational operations. It aims to be a trusted partner for higher-education professionals navigating the rapidly changing ed-tech landscape.